

90 seconds to first interview

A Swiggy tech recruiter reviews 200+ AI-engineer applications weekly. Each portfolio gets 90 seconds. In that window they answer 3 questions: (1) Did they ship real? (2) Can they communicate? (3) Does it match our JD? All YES = interview. Else, next.

Would YOUR portfolio pass the 90-second test today?

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01** 3 + 1 structure
- 02** 8-section README
- 03** Live demo pairs every repo
- 04** About-me page — positioning
- 05** Analogy

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

200 applications a week. 90 seconds each.

WHY

Real

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SCALE

Today

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SPEED

Now

A real reason this matters in industry today.

IMPACT

Yours

A real reason this matters in industry today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

The 90-second recruiter skim.

2

3 anchor projects + 1 thought-piece.

3

README that converts.

4

Pair repo with live demo.

5

Positioning about-me page.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

3 + 1 structure

Depth over breadth

02

8-section README

Contrarian: LIMITATIONS section
INCREASES interview rate. Recruiters
find self-awareness refreshing.

03

**Live demo pairs
every repo**

Free hosting in 2026

04

**About-me page —
positioning**

What you build · who for · evidence

01

PART 1 OF 4

3 + 1 structure

Depth over breadth

CONCEPT 1 OF 4

3 + 1 structure

Anchor 1 — production-shaped AI system (W5-P1 RAG).

Anchor 2 — specialisation (W7 multimodal / edge / Indic).

Anchor 3 — full-stack product (W8 capstone).

Thought-piece — 800-word blog on one thing you learned deeply.

FOCUS

3 + 1

Beats 10 shallow projects.

DEFINITION

3 + 1 structure

Depth over breadth

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

8-section README

Contrarian: LIMITATIONS section INCREASES interview rate. Recruiters find self-awareness refreshing.

KEY POINTS

- Contrarian: LIMITATIONS section INCREASES interview rate. Recruiters find self-awareness refreshing
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

Live demo pairs every repo

Vercel / Render / HuggingFace Spaces.
Keep demo data obviously fake but realistic.
Instrument with basic analytics.
60-second Loom as fallback.
PAIR
Repo + demo
Code alone loses to demos.

DEFINITION

Live demo pairs every repo

Free hosting in 2026

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

About-me page — positioning

Specialty (what you build).
Industry (who you build for).
Evidence (2 line-items with numbers).
What next.
Contact.

EXAMPLE

"Indic voice for rural fintech"

Positioning, not biography.

KEY POINTS

- Specialty (what you build)
- Industry (who you build for)
- Evidence (2 line-items with numbers)
- What next

02

PART 2 OF 4

Engage and reflect

Pause, talk, and connect what you just learned to your own work.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Pause and reflect

PROMPT

Apply the four concepts above to one real example from your own week.

HOW TO RUN IT

1

2

3

4

Reveal: instructor confirms the canonical answer.

REFLECT & APPLY

Three questions before you close this lesson

Spend 60 seconds on each. Write the answers down — no scrolling, no shortcuts.

Q1

Where will you apply this in your next project?

Q2

What was the single biggest 'aha' from this lesson?

Q3

Which habit will you start using this week?

03

PART 3 OF 4

Knowledge check

Three short questions. One minute each. Honest answers only.

3 questions recruiter asks:

A A

B Did they ship? Can they communicate? Does it match JD?

C Random

D Nothing

3 questions recruiter asks:



CORRECT ANSWER

Did they ship? Can they communicate? Does it match JD?

WHY

These three drive interview yes/no

Anchor projects count:

A

B

B

D

C

None

D

(no option)

Anchor projects count:



CORRECT ANSWER

D

WHY

Depth > breadth

LIMITATIONS section effect:

A

Decreases interviews

B

Increases interviews

C

No effect

D

Neutral

LIMITATIONS section effect:

CORRECT ANSWER



Increases interviews

WHY

Shows maturity

04

PART 4 OF 4

Apply and close

One thing to remember. One thing to ship this week.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

WORKED EXAMPLE

How this lesson plays out in one real Indian context

THE SCENARIO

Anchor 1 — production-shaped AI system (W5-P1 RAG).

Anchor 2 — specialisation (W7 multimodal / edge / Indic).

Anchor 3 — full-stack product (W8 capstone).

Thought-piece — 800-word blog on one thing you learned deeply.

FOCUS

3 + 1

Beats 10 shallow projects.

THE TAKEAWAY

The right tool, applied to the right problem, beats the loudest idea every time.

WHAT TO NOTICE

1

3 + 1 structure

2

8-section README

3

Live demo pairs every repo

4

About-me page — positioning

90 seconds. Earn the interview.

"Depth signals seniority. Shallow signals noise."

DELIVERABLES

- NEXT
- Lesson 6 — The Interview.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

“

Knowing the right tool is half the battle. Doing the small thing today is the other half.

— AI Learning Hub

END OF LESSON 8

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

1

Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.

2

Practice the framework on a real example.

3

Watch for the three classic pitfalls.

4

Document your decision in one sentence.

5

Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.